MASTER PROJECT BRIEF

Real-Estate Management & Business Operations System

A detailed product vision, functional blueprint, control model and phased delivery plan

Prepared: 13 October 2026

Specification status: Planning baseline — not approved for implementation

Writing approach: ASD-STE100-inspired. Short sentences, consistent terms, and explicit requirements.

Research approach: Official product documentation and supplier materials for enterprise ERP, real-estate management, workflow, HR, field service, valuation practice and Kenyan compliance context.

Use of benchmark research: The sources inform capability patterns. They do not imply endorsement, direct copying, or a claim that any one product is the correct implementation choice.

Important project boundary

This document describes what the system should become and what must be decided before implementation. No code, database, repository or deployment changes are included in this deliverable.

Contents and how to use this brief

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Read this document as a shared product specification. It is not a database migration script, software architecture decision record, legal opinion, or final accounting policy. Items labelled “proposed” require validation. Items labelled “must” describe a required control or outcome.

1. Executive summary

The proposed product is a unified real-estate operating system for a business that manages properties and tenancies, collects rent, accounts for money held for landlords and clients, performs valuation assignments, sells and lets property, controls company spending, manages staff, and reports business performance.

The product should give each employee one reliable place to complete work. It should give managers an accurate view of the work and exceptions that require attention. It should give finance staff traceable transactions instead of disconnected totals. It should give company administrators strong control over access without creating unnecessary delays in routine operations.

The product is not only a property register. It is a process system. A tenant payment, for example, must move from evidence of receipt to identification, allocation, receipt issuance, reconciliation and reporting. A staff advance must move from request to approval, actual issue of funds, expense retirement, return of unused cash or reimbursement, and closure. A valuation job must connect the instruction, assigned staff, milestones, client deliverable, invoice, collection, costs and financial outcome.

The business outcome

- One source of truth for companies, branches, clients, properties, units, tenancies, jobs, approvals and transactions.
- Reliable financial records that distinguish company money from landlord and client money.
- Controlled payment and expenditure processes with evidence, approvals, reconciliation and audit history.
- Operational dashboards that identify outstanding work, overdue actions, risks and financial exceptions.
- Shared workflows between property management, finance, maintenance, sales, valuation, HR and management.
- An architecture that supports more companies, branches, currencies and modules without rebuilding core records.
- Limited offline support that improves continuity but does not weaken server-side financial controls.

Product ambition

The long-term product can become a connected business platform with configurable workflows, management reporting, integrations, mobile access, and carefully controlled self-service portals. The initial release should not attempt every advanced feature. It must establish accurate shared records, secure access, reliable financial events, and tested operating workflows first.

Core product test

Can an authorised employee complete a real business process from its beginning to its verified outcome, while every relevant person can see the correct status and no one can silently bypass the controls?

2. Product principles and design rules

Principle	Meaning for this product
One shared operational record	A property, client, employee, supplier, tenancy or valuation job should have one authoritative record. Other modules should link to it instead of maintaining conflicting copies.
Process before screen	Design the states, hand-offs, approval rules and exceptions before designing the form. A form is only one step in a business workflow.
Transaction history before totals	Financial balances must be calculated or reconciled from traceable transactions. Do not allow users to edit a total as a substitute for recording the event that changed it.
Separate requested, approved, paid and reconciled	An approved requisition is not proof of payment. A statement row is not automatically a confirmed tenant receipt. A

Principle	Meaning for this product
	completed valuation assignment is not necessarily paid.
Preserve history	Changes to tenancy terms, rent, allocation, employee assignment, approval and financial status must retain sufficient history to explain what changed, who changed it, and when.
Least privilege by default	Users should receive only the company, branch, records and actions required for their role. Expanded access must be explicit, time-limited when possible, and audited.
Server validation is authoritative	The server and database must recheck permissions, record states, totals, duplicate identifiers and approval requirements. A hidden button is not a security control.
Exception-first operations	The system should make missing evidence, overdue actions, unmatched transactions, duplicate candidates and inconsistent balances easy to find.
Automation with traceability	Automation may generate routine charges, reminders and tasks. It must record what it did and avoid repeat execution when retried.
Clear separation of money	Company operating funds, landlord/client liabilities, deposits, branch cash, employee advances and reimbursements must remain distinct in records and reports.
Designed for change	Use configurable categories, approval limits, workflows, templates and reports where requirements vary legitimately. Do not make every setting arbitrary if that increases risk.
Progressive delivery	Ship small, testable releases. Preserve validated functionality and require evidence before changing a core financial or security behaviour.

Language used in the specification

Term	Meaning
Must	Required outcome or control. A release should not pass acceptance if this requirement fails.
Should	Strong recommendation. Any decision not to implement it requires a recorded reason.
May	Optional future capability or configurable choice.
MVP	Minimum viable product: the smallest release that can support real work safely and reliably.
Company	An independent business operating within the platform.
Branch	An organisational unit within a company.
Client funds	Money held or collected for a landlord or another client. It is not automatically company revenue.
Posted transaction	A transaction accepted into the official financial record under defined accounting controls.
Reconciliation	A controlled comparison of independent records to identify and resolve differences.

3. Research benchmark: what leading platforms demonstrate

The benchmark review uses public supplier documentation. It focuses on product patterns that can inform requirements. It does not attempt to reproduce proprietary screens or claim that all features are available in every edition or subscription tier.

3.1 Property management platforms

Yardi Voyager demonstrates the value of connecting property operations and accounting in one data environment. Its public residential documentation describes a shared general ledger, automated move-in and move-out accounting, role-based views, workflow-led leasing, work orders and reporting from property, unit, prospect and resident information [1]. The design lesson is to link tenancy events, maintenance and finance rather than re-entering the same facts in separate systems.

Buildium highlights property-management accounting, payments, owner statements, owner contributions, transaction history, documents, tasks and bank reconciliation [2][3]. Its owner statement guidance includes cash flow, liabilities held, income and expenses, and the amount due to an owner [3]. The design lesson is to create accurate financial statements from source records and show owners' funds and liabilities clearly, even if external portals are deferred.

AppFolio describes connected leasing, maintenance, accounting, reporting, bill approval, owner distributions, receipt capture and unit-turn workflows [4]. The design lesson is to coordinate marketing and leasing with vacancy, maintenance readiness, billing and reporting.

3.2 ERP and financial management platforms

Odoo's official accounting documentation describes multi-company operations, company-specific charts of accounts, cash-basis and accrual-basis reporting, multi-currency transactions and currency gain/loss recognition [5]. Its bank transaction workflow supports imported statement files, including CSV, alongside manual entry and bank synchronisation [6]. Its expense workflow separates employee submission, approval, posting, reimbursement and customer re-invoicing [7]. These patterns support the proposed separation between evidence, approval, posting and actual settlement.

Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central documents approval workflows that can combine user tasks and automated actions [8]. Its finance guidance includes a general ledger, dimensions for richer analysis, currencies and period allocation [9]. The design lesson is to make approvals configurable and attach finance records to dimensions such as company, branch, property, department, job and funding source.

Oracle NetSuite documentation shows how multi-subsidiary and multi-currency design depends on deliberate organisation and base-currency choices [10]. Its multi-book accounting documentation illustrates that one business event may support more than one accounting/reporting basis, but also shows that this is a complex capability requiring careful configuration [11]. The product should therefore be multi-currency ready from its data-model stage without attempting advanced multi-book accounting in the first release.

3.3 Workflow, CRM, offline and specialist systems

Zoho People describes configurable approval workflows for HR requests [12], while Zoho CRM's lead-management documentation describes assignment rules, qualification, follow-up campaigns and conversion reporting [13]. The design lesson is that all workflow modules should share a common approval and task pattern, while each domain retains its own rules and vocabulary.

Microsoft Power Apps documentation explains that offline-capable mobile applications need a defined offline data profile, local storage, synchronisation, sync status and conflict handling [14]. The design lesson is that offline operation is a deliberate data-scope and conflict-resolution feature, not simply local browser storage.

Microsoft Dynamics 365 Field Service describes work orders tied to customers, assets, tasks, required parts, services, scheduling and status tracking [15]. Odoo Maintenance describes corrective and preventive work, assigned teams,

calendars, equipment details and maintenance records [16]. The design lesson is to treat maintenance as a managed job with priority, resource, evidence, costs, parts and completion checks.

RICS guidance for registered valuers emphasises retaining signed and dated terms of engagement and provides valuation instruction and report framework resources [17]. This project does not calculate values or generate valuation opinions. It can use the operational principle that a job file should track instruction, engagement evidence, assigned professionals, progress, deliverable issuance and a defensible record of the work.

Kenya Revenue Authority documentation describes API-based system-to-system integration for eTIMS invoicing, including VSCU and OSCU routes [18]. This should be assessed during compliance and integration design. It is not a reason to assume that any particular tax treatment or implementation is automatically applicable to the company.

The Office of the Data Protection Commissioner identifies the roles of data controller and data processor in the Kenyan data-protection context [19]. The project should map the company's actual role, the data it processes, the providers that process data on its behalf, and the controls and obligations that apply. Legal and compliance conclusions require review by qualified advisers.

3.4 Benchmark synthesis

Pattern to adopt	Product requirement derived from it	What not to copy blindly
Single property and accounting record [1][2][4]	Use one linked source of truth for property, tenancy, charges, payments, maintenance and statements.	Do not assume an overseas trust-accounting model automatically satisfies Kenyan needs.
Owner statements and document access [2][3]	Produce traceable statements and controlled document packets; portals can come later.	Do not expose owner information before permission and release rules are defined.
Configurable workflows [8][12]	Use common workflow infrastructure, conditions, approvers, thresholds and audit events.	Do not build an unrestricted workflow designer before the basic approval model is tested.
Multi-company and multi-currency rules [5][10][11]	Set company scope, functional currency, exchange-rate policy and consolidation assumptions early.	Do not add "currency" as a display label without preserving original amount and conversion details.
Imported bank transactions [6]	Stage CSV rows, validate, match, review exceptions and reconcile before posting.	Do not auto-post unmatched statement lines.
Offline profiles and conflict handling [14]	Define permitted offline tables/actions, queue states, sync, conflicts and local-data protection.	Do not let offline activity bypass authorisation or make final financial decisions locally.
CRM follow-up and conversion reporting [13]	Track sources, next action, owner, stage, conversion and reasons lost.	Do not treat a lead register as a full sales process.
Work orders and valuation files [15][16][17]	Track assignment, milestones, evidence, due dates, costs, deliverables and financial outcome.	Do not confuse operational status with payment status or professional judgement.

Benchmark conclusion

Use the platforms as evidence of mature capability patterns. Build the product around the company's own verified workflows, Kenyan operating context, security model and approved accounting policies.

4. Operating model and connected workflows

4.1 The operating system has four connected layers

Layer	Purpose	Examples
Business records	Store trusted entities and their history.	Company, branch, client, property, unit, tenant, employee, supplier, valuation job.
Operational workflows	Move work through controlled states.	Rent billing, payment matching, maintenance work order, expense request, valuation job.
Financial control	Record the money and establish the financial outcome.	Receivable, payment allocation, client liability, cash advance, invoice, reimbursement, reconciliation.
Visibility and governance	Control access and report status.	Dashboard, approval queue, audit trail, compliance report, branch comparison, data-retention rule.

4.2 Example: tenant rent payment

1. The active tenancy and approved rent schedule establish what is due and for which period.
2. The system generates one charge for the period and links it to the tenant, tenancy, unit, property and client/landlord ledger.
3. A receipt of funds is captured from an authorised manual entry or a reviewed imported transaction.
4. The user or matching rule identifies the payer and allocates the amount to one or more open charges.
5. The system records an allocation. It handles partial payment, overpayment and unallocated amount as separate states.
6. The official receipt is issued under a controlled numbering rule when the defined receipt conditions are met.
7. The relevant cash/bank and client-fund records are updated according to approved accounting policy.
8. A reviewer reconciles the transaction to independent bank or payment evidence.
9. The tenant statement, arrears report and landlord statement derive from those same source records.

4.3 Example: employee advance and retirement

10. Employee submits an advance request with purpose, amount, currency, branch, cost centre or property, due date and supporting evidence.
11. Approval rules select the correct approver based on amount, category and organisation scope.
12. Finance records the actual issue of cash or funds. Approval alone does not create a paid advance.
13. The employee records each expense and attaches receipts or other evidence.
14. The custodian or finance reviewer checks category, amount, purpose, duplicate evidence and any property/client recoverability.
15. The employee returns unused money or submits a supported claim for additional reimbursement.
16. Finance reconciles the advance and records the correct accounting outcome.
17. The employee's dashboard shows any remaining amount owed by the employee or reimbursement owed by the company.
18. The record closes only when the approved retirement and cash outcome are complete.

4.4 Example: valuation job

19. Record the client instruction, scope, location, fee arrangement, due date and required engagement documents.
20. Assign a job number, responsible valuer and support staff. Record conflicts, dependencies or missing information where applicable.

21. Track milestones such as inspection arranged, information received, fieldwork complete, review due and deliverable issued.
22. Record actual completion and deliverable issuance as separate events.
23. Create the invoice or fee claim according to the company's approved policy.
24. Record receipts, outstanding balance, direct costs and any approved expense recharge.
25. Review job profitability and close the operational and financial components independently.

4.5 Common lifecycle states

Lifecycle	Recommended states	Rule
Workflow item	Draft → Submitted → In review → Approved / Rejected → Completed / Cancelled	A rejection or cancellation requires a reason. State changes are logged.
Payment request	Draft → Submitted → Approved → Payment instructed → Paid → Reconciled	Do not use "paid" until actual payment evidence is recorded.
Imported statement row	Imported → Validated → Matched / Exception → Approved → Posted / Excluded	Keep the source row. Record duplicate and exclusion decisions.
Maintenance request	Reported → Triaged → Approved if required → Assigned → In progress → Awaiting inspection → Completed / Reopened	A completed status needs completion evidence and cost status where relevant.
Valuation job	Instruction received → Registered → Assigned → In progress → Review → Delivered → Financially tracked → Closed	The job can be delivered but unpaid. Do not collapse operational and financial statuses.
Offline action	Local draft → Queued → Syncing → Accepted / Conflict / Rejected	Display the status clearly. An accepted action must return a server-confirmed identifier.

5.1 Company dashboard and employee work queue

The dashboard is the daily operating surface. It should show the user what requires attention, what is due next, what has changed and which financial or operational exceptions must be resolved. It must not show a misleading single headline total that combines unlike currencies, companies or types of liability.

Typical workflow User signs in → system resolves company, branch, role and delegated tasks → dashboard loads authorised counters → user opens an item → task is completed or escalated → source record and audit history update.

Capabilities required

- Role-aware dashboard tiles for rent due, arrears, payments awaiting allocation, maintenance backlog, valuation milestones, pending approvals, requisitions, cash advances and assigned tasks.
- Prioritised work queue with owner, due date, urgency, status, related record and next action.
- Exception cards for failed imports, duplicate candidates, unresolved bank differences, overdue expense retirements, incomplete files, expired access and overdue jobs.
- Personal view, team view, branch view and authorised company-wide view.
- Drill-through from a metric to the records that make up the number.
- Saved filters and sensible date windows, with transparent calculation definitions.
- Notification centre with read/unread status, source record and action link.
- Dashboards that remain usable on desktop and mobile screens.

Principal records and relationships

User profile, company/branch membership, dashboard preferences, task, notification, exception item, metric definitions, and links to authoritative module records.

Controls and exception handling

- The dashboard queries only data the user is permitted to view.
- Every metric must have a defined formula, date basis, currency and scope.
- Stale offline data must be labelled.
- A notification must not expose sensitive details beyond the user's access.
- High-risk alerts must identify the record and next action; they must not only use colour.

Useful measures

Open approvals by age; overdue tasks; arrears by ageing band; unallocated receipts; unretired advances; maintenance SLA; valuation jobs past due; exceptions unresolved; branches needing action.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: Role-based tiles, task queue, approval counts, urgent exceptions and drill-through. Later capability: Personalised layouts, trend comparisons, predictive warning and advanced business intelligence.

Risks to resolve Define the management indicators and formulas. Too many tiles create noise. Overly broad company-wide views can reveal sensitive financial or staff information.

5.2 Organisation, companies, branches, users and access

The system must support multiple independent companies. Each company can contain several branches. Company identity, permissions and financial records must remain separate by default. Branch managers should not receive unrestricted access to other branches merely because they have a management title.

Typical workflow Platform onboarding creates a company → company administrator establishes branches and roles → staff accounts are invited → memberships and default scope are assigned → exceptional access is requested and approved → access is reviewed, expires or is revoked.

Capabilities required

- Company registration, status, contact details, base/reporting currency, time zone, financial-year settings and controlled configuration.
- Branch registry with address, operational manager, reporting identity, cash custodian, and permitted modules.
- User identity separated from company membership. One identity may belong to multiple companies if approved.
- Role catalogue and permission matrix with view, create, edit, approve, post, export, administer and delete/archive distinctions.
- Role assignments by company and branch; temporary assignments; transfer history; absence coverage.
- Time-limited cross-branch access with purpose, requested actions, approver, expiry and complete audit events.
- Joiner, mover, leaver process: provision, change, suspend, revoke and transfer open tasks.
- Restricted platform-support access that is separate from company administration and recorded.
- Periodic access review and reports for dormant, duplicate, over-privileged or expired accounts.

Principal records and relationships

Company, branch, user identity, company membership, branch membership, role, permission, approval, access request, temporary delegation, login/session event and audit event.

Controls and exception handling

- Default deny; enforce scope at server and database level.
- No user approves their own access expansion.
- Company A users cannot read Company B records by changing a URL or API request.
- Branch transfer does not rewrite historical ownership of completed records.
- Support access must be purpose-limited, logged and time-bound.

- Revoked users cannot continue to perform actions through old sessions or queued offline changes.

Useful measures

Access requests pending; access exceptions expiring; inactive accounts; users with privileged roles; unauthorised access attempts; unresolved access reviews.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: Company/branch hierarchy, user membership, role-based permissions, basic approval-based access and audit log. Later capability: Single sign-on options, advanced identity governance, delegated administration, access certification and anomaly detection.

Risks to resolve Confirm company administrator recovery, multi-company users, emergency break-glass access, branch manager powers, and separation between platform operations and customer data access.

5.3 Property, units, clients, tenants, tenancies and charges

This module maintains the operational register for managed properties. It must separate a property, a rentable unit, its owner, a tenant, a tenancy agreement, and each financial charge. A vacancy or tenant departure must not remove the historical record.

Typical workflow Property registered → units defined → ownership and management mandate recorded → tenant and tenancy linked → rent schedule and charge rules approved → periodic charges generated → occupancy changes recorded with an effective date → history remains available.

Capabilities required

- Property profile with unique identifier, name, address, property type, ownership relationships, manager, branch, management start/end dates, status and key documents.
- Unit register with unit identifier, type, floor/position where relevant, occupancy status, rent basis, amenities and unit-specific terms.
- Ownership or landlord relationships that allow one landlord to own several properties and a property to have approved ownership splits if the business requires them.
- Client register with person or business type, contact channels, addresses, communication preferences and restricted identity/tax fields.
- Tenant and occupier records separated from tenancy contract records. A tenant may have multiple tenancies over time.
- Tenancy agreement metadata: tenant(s), unit, start/end date, renewal option, deposit, billing cycle, due date, grace period, approved rent, review rule, included services and signed documents.
- Rent schedules with effective dates. Changes must not silently rewrite old periods or charges.
- Configurable charge catalogue for rent, service charge, utilities, parking, penalties and other approved categories.
- Charge generation preview and exception reporting before or after a controlled posting run, as policy requires.
- Move-in, move-out, handover, inspection, key register and unit turnover tasks.
- Vacancy management: marketing status, repair dependency, ready-to-let status and reasons for lost days.
- Property and unit history, including former occupiers, prior rent terms and approved changes.

Principal records and relationships

Properties, units, client/landlord records, tenants, tenancy agreements, rent schedules, charge definitions, charges, deposits, unit inspections, documents and linked maintenance requests.

Controls and exception handling

- Each property and unit has a stable unique identifier. Names alone are not unique keys.
- A unit cannot have overlapping active exclusive tenancies unless an approved business rule permits it.
- Rent or service-charge changes require an effective date, authority and audit entry.

- Recurring billing must be idempotent: the same property/unit/tenancy/charge period must not be billed twice.
- Occupancy status must be consistent with tenancy dates and exceptions visible.
- Sensitive tenant fields require narrower access than ordinary property details.
- Charge generation must preview skipped, duplicated or invalid records.

Useful measures

Occupied and vacant units; occupancy by branch/property/type; days vacant; upcoming expiries; renewals due; rent changes; incomplete tenancy documents; properties under management; unit turnover time.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: Property, unit, client, tenant, tenancy, rent schedule, recurring charge foundation and history. Later capability: Advanced lease abstracts, bulk renewal runs, inspection mobile checklists, owner/tenant portals, lease document extraction and portfolio optimisation.

Risks to resolve Confirm property categories, landlord mandates, service charge methods, billing periods, utility billing, penalties, deposit arrangements and the exact meaning of tenancy status.

5.4 Payments, allocations, receipts, arrears and landlord statements

This module turns received-funds evidence into correctly identified, allocated, auditable financial records. It must support partial payment, overpayment, payment received for multiple charges, unidentified funds, reversals and adjustments. Landlord statements must explain the movement of money; they must not be an editable summary typed by hand.

Typical workflow Charge becomes due → payment evidence received → payment recorded or imported → payer and destination identified → payment allocated to charges or held unallocated → receipt issued under policy → financial reconciliation → landlord statement generated from approved source transactions.

Capabilities required

- Manual payment capture for authorised users with date, payer, amount, currency, channel, reference, receiving bank/cash account, property/tenancy where known and evidence.
- Payment allocation across one or more charges while preserving the original receipt amount.
- Partial payments and arrears calculated at charge level, not inferred from a free-text note.
- Overpayment treatment as credit, refundable balance or unallocated amount under approved policy.
- Unallocated receipts queue with age, suspected payer, matching candidates, owner and resolution reason.
- Receipt numbering with uniqueness under concurrent use, and clear issue, void, reversal and reprint rules.
- Credit notes, adjustments and reversals that preserve history and correctly update balances.
- Arrears ageing with charge due date, days overdue, amount disputed and collection action history.
- Collection notes, promises to pay, reminders, escalation and authorised fee/penalty treatment.
- Landlord statement showing opening balance, collections, fees, approved expenses, withholding or deposits where applicable, payments/disbursements, closing balance and supporting transaction detail.
- Payout proposal with available-funds calculation, approvals, actual payment evidence and reconciliation.
- Tenant statement and payment history with traceability to source transactions.

Principal records and relationships

Charges, payment transactions, payment allocations, receipts, bank/cash accounts, refunds, credit adjustments, arrears actions, landlord ledgers, payout batches and statement periods.

Controls and exception handling

- Never change the source payment to make an allocation appear correct; use explicit allocation, reversal or adjustment records.
- Do not issue duplicate receipts on retry. Reprint must be clearly distinct from new issuance.
- Prevent allocation greater than the available payment amount or charge balance unless an explicit credit workflow permits it.
- Do not mark a landlord payout paid before actual transfer evidence is recorded.
- Reconcile the landlord/client liability to collections, approved expenses, fees, refunds and payouts.
- Statements must be reproducible for the same period and source-data version. Reissued statements should be labelled and retain release history.

Useful measures

Collection rate; arrears by age; unallocated amount/value and age; receipts awaiting review; average days to allocate; landlord amount due; payout ageing; payment reversals; statement exception count.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: Payment entry, allocation, receipt controls, arrears, unallocated queue, basic landlord statement and payout tracking. Later capability: Real-time payment-provider integrations, payment links, scheduled payouts, controlled statement portal, automated collection communications and richer dispute handling.

Risks to resolve Confirm receipt tax meaning, receipt triggers, tenant credit handling, partial allocation priority, deposits, refund approval, landlord statement timing and what funds may be used for fees or expenses.

5.5 Finance and accounting

The finance module is the common financial control layer for the entire system. It must support reliable operational finance now and a controlled path to fuller cash and accrual accounting. It must distinguish the company's assets, revenue and costs from money owed to landlords, clients, employees, suppliers and other parties.

Typical workflow Business event is recorded → policy determines financial impact → invoice, receivable, payable or advance is created as appropriate → approval is applied → cash/bank movement is recorded → accounting record is posted under the authorised workflow → statement reconciliation and period review identify differences.

Capabilities required

- Chart of accounts and account groups, with controlled changes, effective dates and role restrictions.
- Financial periods, close status, reopening authority and period-end checklist.
- General ledger foundation with balanced journal entries and immutable posting history.
- Accounts receivable: customer/tenant/valuation invoices, payment allocations, credit notes, disputed balances and ageing.
- Accounts payable: supplier invoices, employee claims, payment proposal, approval, actual payment and ageing.
- Cash and bank accounts including account owner/company, currency, purpose and reconciliation rules.
- Accounting dimensions such as company, branch, property, client/landlord, cost centre, business unit, valuation job and funding source.
- Multiple currencies, original transaction amount, functional currency amount, rate, rate date, rounding and exchange differences.
- Accrual-capable records for earned revenue, incurred costs, prepayments, accrued expenses and deferrals, subject to approved accounting policy.
- Client-fund liability and landlord sub-ledgers distinct from company operating funds.
- Deposit liabilities, refund status and reconciliation, where applicable.
- Journal posting rules tied to business events, with validation and period restrictions.
- Budget and actual comparisons, branch financial performance, property profitability, valuation job margin and cash forecasts.

- Tax codes and e-invoicing integration points, kept separate from tax advice and subject to compliance validation.
- Controlled correction process using reversing entries, credit notes or adjustments rather than silently editing posted entries.

Principal records and relationships

Accounts, financial periods, journal entries/lines, invoices, invoice lines, payment transactions, allocations, credit notes, bank accounts, cash accounts, reconciliations, dimensions, currencies, exchange rates, client balances and close checklist.

Controls and exception handling

- Each posted journal entry balances in its transaction/accounting currency under the approved accounting model.
- Posted entries cannot be silently overwritten or deleted. Correct through controlled reversal or adjustment.
- A document's outstanding balance must derive from invoice amount, credits and allocations.
- Cash basis and accrual basis reports must be labelled and calculated under the approved policy.
- Client funds and deposits must not be reported as company income without a valid accounting basis.
- Period lock prevents unauthorised backdating; reopening is restricted and logged.
- Every automatic posting rule must have an accountable owner and test cases.
- Currency conversion and rounding rules must be deterministic and auditable.

Useful measures

Cash position; operating revenue and costs; receivables/payables ageing; client-fund liability; unreconciled bank items; branch/property profitability; budget variance; period close status; exchange differences.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: Core cash/bank transactions, receivables/payables, financial dimensions, client-fund separation, import/reconciliation, basic double-entry-ready structure and audited adjustments. Later capability: Full general ledger operations, tax/localisation, budgeting, recurring journals, consolidated reporting, fixed assets, depreciation, advanced accruals and external accounting integration where required.

Risks to resolve Accountant must approve chart of accounts, revenue recognition, client-fund treatment, deposits, taxes, currency policy, accounting periods and whether the system becomes the official ledger or integrates with another accounting package.

5.6 Requisitions, procurement, petty cash and employee balances

This module controls how the company commits and spends money. It must handle internal payment requisitions, supplier buying, fixed branch petty cash, ad hoc advances and employee expense claims. These workflows can share approval and financial services but must remain distinct when their accounting or evidence requirements differ.

Typical workflow Need identified → request prepared → budget/authority checks → required approvals → order or payment instruction → actual goods/service or funds received → invoice/claim checked → payment recorded → cash or cost reconciled → record closed.

Capabilities required

- Requisition form with requester, branch, purpose, amount, currency, required date, cost category, supplier/beneficiary, property/job, budget/cost centre and attachments.
- Configurable approval paths by category, amount, branch, client/property funding source and risk.
- Purchase request, quotation collection, supplier comparison, purchase order, receipt of goods/services, invoice matching and payment request.

- Supplier register with payment details under restricted access, tax information where needed, contacts, performance and risk flags.
- Fixed imprest register with float limit, custodian, approved replenishments, receipts, counted cash and reconciliation.
- Ad hoc advance for specific purpose, employee, amount, issue date, expected retirement date and permitted spend categories.
- Expense claim for money personally spent by an employee, including line items, receipts, business purpose and optional customer/property recharge.
- Cash retirement to record expenses, unused cash returned and additional reimbursement due.
- Separation between requester, approver, payer, petty cash custodian and reconciler where practical.
- Duplicate receipt/document checks and exception queues for missing evidence, unusual amounts, late retirement or policy breach.
- Employee dashboard with advance owed by employee, approved claim owed by company, paid/reconciled status and due dates.
- Commitment tracking for approved requisitions and purchase orders before actual payment.
- Supplier invoice and payment relationship with remittance evidence.

Principal records and relationships

Expense requests/items, approval actions, quotations, purchase orders/lines, goods/service receipt, supplier invoices, payments, cash advances, expense claims/items, cash retirements, petty cash accounts, staff balance ledger and attachments.

Controls and exception handling

- A request is not a payment; an approved amount is not proof of payment.
- A staff advance remains open until evidence and cash outcome reconcile.
- Do not offset employee debt and company reimbursement into one ambiguous balance.
- One employee cannot approve their own claim when independent approval is required.
- A petty cash custodian must record actual cash counted and explain shortages/overages.
- Replenishment should derive from eligible approved spend and the authorised float, not a manual target total alone.
- Supplier payment must be linked to a validated invoice or approved exception.
- Property/client recoverability must be explicit and approved; do not charge all business expense to a landlord by default.

Useful measures

Pending requests by value and age; approval time; advance ageing; overdue retirement; imprest reconciliation variance; employee reimbursement payable; supplier payable; spend by category/property/branch; unsupported or repeated claims.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: Digital requisitions, approval matrix, both cash models, employee claims, advances, retirement, evidence, basic procurement and staff balances. Later capability: Purchase order automation, supplier onboarding, three-way match, budget commitments, tender thresholds, card feeds, stock/parts, recurring supplier contracts and anomaly flags.

Risks to resolve Confirm approval bands, float custodians, imprest replenishment frequency, advance limits, receipt exceptions, procurement thresholds, supplier selection rules and who controls bank beneficiary changes.

5.7 Bank CSV imports and reconciliation

The first external payment-capture route will be CSV import. Imported data must be treated as untrusted source evidence until it passes format checks, duplicate checks, matching and review. A CSV import must not post directly into final balances without the required controls.

Typical workflow CSV uploaded → source file and batch registered → mapping applied → rows normalised → validation results displayed → duplicates and likely matches identified → exceptions reviewed → permitted transactions approved and posted → source statement reconciled → batch closed with variance report.

Capabilities required

- Import profile per bank/provider/export type with date format, decimal style, columns, encoding and reference rules.
- Upload receipt with file hash or equivalent identity, uploader, timestamp, company, bank account, statement period and original-file retention.
- Staging table for each row, preserving original values and source row number.
- Validation for missing date/amount/reference, invalid currency, unsupported sign convention and malformed values.
- Duplicate detection using provider transaction ID where available and otherwise a controlled composite candidate, not reference text alone.
- Candidate matching against receipts, charges, supplier payments, client payouts and other known transactions.
- Manual matching, split allocation, one-to-many/many-to-one handling where the business case requires it, and reasoned unmatched outcomes.
- Separate handling for fees, reversals, transfers between company accounts and deposits not yet identified.
- Reconciliation view comparing statement opening/closing balance and rows with the system's recorded entries.
- Batch summary with total rows, valid rows, duplicates, matched, unmatched, excluded, posted and reconciliation variance.
- Retry-safe processing so re-upload or interrupted synchronisation cannot repeat a financial posting.

Principal records and relationships

Import batch, source file, source row, import profile/mapping, validation issue, matching candidate, payment transaction, reconciliation item, reviewer action and audit event.

Controls and exception handling

- Preserve original file and source rows.
- Do not auto-post uncertain matches.
- Keep a row-level explanation of rejection, duplication, exclusion or correction.
- Use stable idempotency keys and database constraints where possible.
- Restrict upload, approve and post permissions separately where risk requires it.
- Do not accept a zero-variance reconciliation merely because rows were excluded without explanation.

Useful measures

Import error rate; duplicate count; unmatched count/value; time to reconcile; number and age of open exceptions; difference between statement balance and book balance.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: CSV upload, preview, configurable mapping, validation, duplicate warnings, review queue and controlled posting/reconciliation. Later capability: Additional bank formats, M-Pesa exports/API integration, bank feeds, rules-based auto-match with confidence bands, scheduled imports and multi-account reconciliation.

Risks to resolve Identify the first bank/payment providers and sample files. Confirm overlap handling, bank fees, reversal conventions, transfer matching, data retention and authorisation to download/upload statements.

5.8 Valuation job operations

The valuation module is an assignment-management and commercial-control system. It does not calculate property values or produce a valuation opinion. It tracks the work performed by the firm, the evidence and milestones associated with each assignment, the issue of the deliverable, and the associated financial outcome.

Typical workflow Instruction received → engagement and scope checked → job registered → responsible professional and support team assigned → milestones and due dates tracked → review completed → deliverable issued → fee invoiced or claimed under policy → payments and costs recorded → job and financial records closed.

Capabilities required

- Job register with unique job number, client, property/location, instruction date, job type, purpose, scope summary, intended user where relevant, fee, currency, due date and assigned branch.
- Terms of engagement checklist and signed-file location; scope changes and client instructions recorded as dated events.
- Conflict/dependency and missing-information flags where the firm's procedures require them.
- Assignment of lead valuer, support staff, reviewer and administrative owner.
- Configurable milestone templates per job type and deadline rules.
- Site visit scheduling and completion status if used by the firm, without performing valuation calculations.
- Checklist for required evidence and internal review.
- Deliverable register showing version/reference, issue date, recipient, method and approving person; the document itself remains in controlled storage.
- Agreed fee, invoice trigger, invoice number, receipts, outstanding balance, expenses and direct cost allocation.
- Client changes, pause reason, overdue reason, withdrawal/cancellation, write-off or dispute history.
- Reminder for upcoming deadlines, missing documents, review delay, unissued deliverables and unpaid completed jobs.
- Job profitability by fee earned or billed under approved policy, direct costs, external fees and collected cash shown as distinct measures.

Principal records and relationships

Valuation jobs, client/property links, instruction, engagement documents, staff assignments, milestones, site visit, deliverable metadata, invoices, payments, job costs, approvals and events.

Controls and exception handling

- Completed work and collected cash must remain separate statuses.
- Deliverable issue must record who authorised release and which version was issued.
- Fee recognition and invoice trigger must follow a company-approved rule, not be inferred from completion alone.
- Job file access must be restricted if scope, client data or documents are confidential.
- A cancelled job must retain the reason and financial treatment.
- Costs charged to clients or landlords require evidence and approval.

Useful measures

Jobs received/completed; jobs by stage; overdue milestones; average turnaround; fee billed/collected; unpaid completed jobs; direct cost; margin; cancellations; outstanding documents.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: Job register, assignment, milestones, due-date alerts, deliverable tracking, fee and payment status, direct cost capture and audit history. Later capability: Template-driven job packs, advanced resource capacity, client portals, e-signature integration, automated engagement reminders and portfolio analytics.

Risks to resolve Confirm job categories, mandatory documents, engagement approval, milestone templates, review/release authority, invoicing trigger, retainer/deposit rules and cost allocation policy. RICS guidance is a reference for professional process documentation, not a substitute for the firm's applicable standards [17].

5.9 Sales and lettings CRM

This module manages prospective business from first contact to a concluded sale or letting. It must keep enquiry history, follow-up responsibility, property availability and commercial outcomes connected. A lead list alone is not enough; the system should make the next required action visible.

Typical workflow Lead captured → source and consent/preferences recorded as appropriate → qualification → agent assigned → follow-up scheduled → viewing or consultation → offer/negotiation → accepted or lost → transaction/tenancy handoff → commission and outcome reported.

Capabilities required

- Lead capture from phone, walk-in, referral, listing channels, website or approved campaign imports.
- Client and contact deduplication with links to existing landlords, tenants, buyers, sellers or corporate clients.
- Lead source, interest, budget range, preferred location/type, urgency, owner, stage and next action.
- Configurable sales and letting pipelines with separate stage definitions and required fields.
- Viewing calendar, attendance/outcome, property feedback and follow-up action.
- Offer and negotiation history with amount, currency, terms, date, status and authorisation if required.
- Property listing availability, marketing state, asking rent/price, key attributes, photos/documents and listing expiry.
- Sale/letting transaction checklist and handoff to property management, tenancy onboarding, finance and legal/admin tasks.
- Commission rules, expected commission, triggers, split arrangements if used, actual collection and outstanding amount.
- Lost reason, competitor/source insight, conversion and time-in-stage reporting.
- Task reminders and controlled contact history across email, calls, meetings and messages where integrated.

Principal records and relationships

Leads, contacts/clients, property listings, viewings, offers, opportunities, transactions, commissions, tasks, communications, campaign source and tenancy handoff.

Controls and exception handling

- Avoid duplicate client records. Provide merge with history preservation.
- Restrict personal data and documents by business need.
- Track listing and offer history instead of overwriting historic advertised terms.
- Record who changed an offer or marked a deal as concluded.
- Do not create an active tenancy from an accepted offer until required approval and documents are complete.

Useful measures

Lead response time; follow-up completion; viewing-to-offer rate; lead-to-deal conversion; pipeline value by stage; loss reasons; listing days on market; commission outstanding.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: Lead register, agent assignment, follow-up tasks, viewings, pipeline, property listing links and reporting. Later capability: Web lead forms, campaign automation, e-signatures, listing syndication, advanced communications, self-service scheduling and AI-assisted lead summarisation.

Risks to resolve Confirm sales and letting stages, deal authority, listing channels, commission structure, data-consent language, offer documentation and the point at which records transfer into tenancy management.

5.10 Marketing and client relationships

The marketing module supports business development and client retention. It must show which activities produce enquiries and assignments, and connect campaign results to CRM records. Campaign measurement should use a consistent source model rather than rely on staff memory.

Typical workflow Campaign planned → audience and channel approved → content and budget prepared → campaign released → leads attributed to source → enquiries assigned and followed up → conversions and costs measured → campaign reviewed.

Capabilities required

- Client segmentation by relationship, service interest, location, past activity and permitted communication preference.
- Campaign calendar, owner, channel, objective, budget, content approval and schedule.
- Enquiry attribution to campaign, listing source, referral or other channel.
- Reusable approved templates for notices, property marketing, client updates and follow-up.
- Marketing asset library with rights/approval metadata for images, video, documents and listing content.
- Campaign expenditure linked to requisition, supplier invoice and approved budget.
- Communication preference, suppression/opt-out and do-not-contact handling where required.
- Service reminders for lease renewals, management mandate review, valuation follow-up and dormant client relationships.
- Campaign and channel reports that show spend, leads, qualified opportunities, concluded jobs and return measures.
- Brand, content and listing approvals with version tracking.

Principal records and relationships

Campaigns, channels, audiences/segments, content assets, approved templates, leads, communications, source attribution, budget and marketing expenses.

Controls and exception handling

- Do not send campaigns to people who are not permitted under the company's approved communication rules.
- Track consent or other approved communication basis where required by policy and law.
- Keep source data and attribution rules consistent across reports.
- Record campaign approval and final content version.
- Restrict use of property images and confidential client documents to authorised purposes.

Useful measures

Leads by source; cost per qualified lead; campaign spend; conversion by channel; response time; returning client activity; opt-out rate; dormant clients due for review.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: Campaign register, source attribution, content approval and CRM follow-up tracking. Later capability: Automated campaign sequences, email/SMS/WhatsApp integrations, audience scoring, landing pages and campaign ROI dashboards.

Risks to resolve Confirm approved communication channels, opt-out handling, provider contracts, marketing budget limits, content responsibilities and permitted use of property images/data.

5.11 Maintenance, suppliers, assets and property readiness

The maintenance module manages faults and repairs from reporting to verification and cost closure. It should include both reactive repair and preventive work where applicable. A maintenance request must remain linked to its property/unit and, where relevant, a tenancy, supplier, expense approval and invoice.

Typical workflow Issue reported or preventive work becomes due → request triaged → urgency and responsibility assigned → approval obtained if required → internal team or supplier assigned → work and costs tracked → completion evidence supplied → inspection/acceptance completed → expense allocated and record closed.

Capabilities required

- Maintenance request with property/unit, reporter, issue, date, severity, access constraints, safety risk, photos and contact details.
- Prioritisation rules for emergencies, habitability, safety, business interruption and routine work.
- Work orders with tasks, responsible staff, due date, planned visit, status, required materials, labour and estimated cost.
- Supplier register, service categories, contacts, licence/insurance evidence where relevant, agreed rates and performance history.
- Quotation request, comparison, approval, purchase order/expense reference, supplier invoice and payment links.
- Landlord/client chargeability decision and approval, with reason and evidence.
- Preventive maintenance schedules for selected assets/equipment and recurring inspections.
- Unit readiness or turn board for work required before marketing, viewing or move-in.
- Completion checklist, before/after evidence, user/manager acceptance and reopen workflow.
- Warranty, recurring fault, service history, maintenance cost and supplier performance.
- Escalation when deadlines are missed, budgets exceeded or safety risks remain unresolved.

Principal records and relationships

Maintenance requests, work orders, property/unit links, assignment, supplier, quotations, approved expenditure, inventory/parts where used, invoice/payment, evidence and asset history.

Controls and exception handling

- Urgency changes must be logged. Emergency handling must still produce a retrospective record and review.
- Do not close a work order without required completion evidence or a documented exception.
- Supplier invoices should link to approved work/quotation or record an exception.
- Client-recoverable cost must be explicitly approved.
- Separate the person who requests work, approves cost and verifies completion where possible.
- Emergency and non-emergency service levels must be explicit.

Useful measures

Open work by severity; time to acknowledge/assign/resolve; overdue jobs; repeat faults; cost variance; maintenance spend per property/unit; supplier response; vacancy days due to repairs.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: Request register, priority, assignment, work order, quotations/approvals, evidence, expenses and completion tracking. Later capability: Preventive maintenance calendar, mobile field work, stock/parts, supplier portal, route planning, asset lifecycle, budget forecasting and automated service reminders.

Risks to resolve Confirm emergency response expectations, service levels, landlord consent rules, quote thresholds, supplier vetting, work acceptance authority, property safety checklist and preventive maintenance scope. Benchmark patterns reflect Odoo maintenance and Dynamics field-service work orders [15][16].

5.12 HR and employee administration

The HR module maintains the company's staff structure and supports authorised employee processes. It must connect staff identity, branch assignment, approval responsibility and employee financial balances while restricting access to confidential records.

Typical workflow Employee approved → profile created → company/branch/manager/role assigned → required documents and training recorded → leave or attendance event submitted → appropriate approval completed → payroll/finance-related consequences passed to the authorised process → history retained.

Capabilities required

- Employee register with staff identifier, legal/preferred name, contact details, employment status, position, department, manager, company, branch and start/end dates.
- Role and reporting structure linked to permission assignments but not treated as identical to job title.
- Controlled document checklist for employment agreement, identity/tax records and other documents required by approved policy.
- Onboarding and offboarding task lists, assigned equipment and access provisioning/revocation.
- Leave types, entitlement rules, application, manager approval, calendar and handover arrangements.
- Attendance or time records if required, with correction and approval history.
- Training, certification or professional credential expiry tracking where relevant.
- Performance or probation milestones if the company chooses to include them.
- Staff advance, expense claim and reimbursement links to finance.
- Employee documents access by HR role; line managers see only approved operational information.
- Staff movement and branch-transfer history with effective dates.

Principal records and relationships

Employee, employment record, organisation/department, manager, leave request, attendance record, document, training/credential, assigned equipment, access membership and employee finance record.

Controls and exception handling

- HR access to personal data must be narrower than standard manager access.
- Do not delete financial or approval history after staff departure.
- Offboarding must revoke system access and transfer open tasks.
- Leave/attendance corrections must preserve old and new values and authorisation.
- Confidential pay, identity and disciplinary records require separate permission classes.

Useful measures

Headcount by branch/role; vacancies and joiners/leavers; leave queue; leave liability where relevant; incomplete onboarding; credential expiry; advances and claims by employee.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: Staff register, branch and manager assignments, onboarding/offboarding, leave requests and employee finance links. Later capability: Recruitment pipeline, advanced attendance, payroll integration, scheduling, appraisal, training plans and HR analytics.

Risks to resolve Confirm which employment records should be stored, lawful purpose and retention, attendance device/integration needs, payroll provider, leave policy and confidentiality rules. HR law and tax treatment require qualified review.

5.13 Tasks, documents, approvals and notifications

These are shared services for all modules. Every workflow should use a consistent task, document, approval and notification pattern while preserving the rules that belong to the specific business process.

Typical workflow Business event creates task or approval → owner and due date assigned → evidence attached → reviewer acts with reason → next task or system action is triggered → participants are notified → full event trail remains searchable.

Capabilities required

- Task with title, description, owner, requester, priority, due date, related record, checklist, dependency, status and escalation route.
- Subtasks and recurring tasks for inspections, statement review, valuation milestones, access reviews and period close.
- Document repository with folder/record link, document type, version, author, creation date, access policy, retention rule and expiry date.
- Metadata and content search for authorised users; controlled download and sharing.
- Approval definitions with requester, eligible approver, amount/risk conditions, sequence, quorum where applicable, delegation and escalation.
- Approval action with decision, reason, timestamp, comments and referenced document version.
- Notifications in the application and, later, approved email/SMS channels; delivery failure must be visible.
- Templates for recurring approval paths and task checklists.
- Comments and internal notes with privacy controls, audit history and clear distinction from official financial records.
- Electronic signature provider integration if required, with signed file and status retention.
- Full-text search across allowed metadata and document content where safe.

Principal records and relationships

Tasks, task assignments, task history, approval workflow, approval steps/actions, document files/metadata/versions, notification, preference, delivery event, comment and audit event.

Controls and exception handling

- A document linked to a record must follow the record's access policy.
- Replacing a signed or issued document must create a new version.
- Rejected approvals require a reason.
- Delegated approver authority must be explicit and time-bound.
- Approval changes cannot rewrite an earlier decision.
- Notifications do not grant access; the server rechecks permissions when the user opens the item.
- No user can delete audit evidence for an action they performed.

Useful measures

Overdue tasks; approvals by age; rejected requests by reason; tasks reopened; unviewed critical notifications; expired documents; approval cycle time; document search success.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: Common tasks, documents, multi-step approvals, audit events, in-app notifications and due-date reminders. Later capability: Advanced workflow builder, e-signature, document OCR/indexing, smart reminders and integrations with office productivity tools.

Risks to resolve Confirm document retention and disposal, signature method, external sharing policy, escalation periods, delegation rules and whether workflow configuration belongs to company admins or platform admins. Configurable workflows are a repeated pattern in Business Central and Zoho People [8][12].

5.14 Reporting, dashboards and management intelligence

The reporting module turns operational records into consistent information for managers and staff. Reports must show where their numbers come from. A user should be able to open a reported total and inspect the authorised source records or understand why drill-through is restricted.

Typical workflow Records are created and validated → common measures are calculated → report scope and date range are selected → authorised report is generated → user drills into details or exports → report and any important distribution are recorded where required.

Capabilities required

- Operational dashboards for property, finance, valuation, maintenance, sales/lettings, HR and approvals.
- Financial reports for cash, receivables, payables, client-fund liabilities, property income/expense, valuation fee and cost, and branch results.
- Rent collection, arrears, occupancy, vacancy, renewal and tenancy expiry reports.
- Workflow reports: pending approval, ageing, process duration, rejection reason and repeated exception.
- Sales/lettings pipeline, conversion, source, agent, deal outcome and commission collection.
- Maintenance SLA, ageing, recurring faults, supplier performance, expenditure and readiness delays.
- Valuation job pipeline, due dates, completion, fees billed/collected, direct costs and margin.
- Petty cash balance, advance ageing, outstanding reimbursements, unretired advances and unreconciled float.
- Multi-currency report labels and approved translation/consolidation rules.
- Saved reports, consistent filters, scheduled delivery, controlled export and report definitions.
- Data quality indicators for missing mandatory fields, orphan records, duplicates and reconciliation differences.
- Management trends, budget-versus-actual analysis and forecasts when source data is reliable.

Principal records and relationships

Report definitions, metric definitions, filters, source links, reporting snapshots when needed, export records, dashboard preferences and data-quality issues.

Controls and exception handling

- Every KPI has an owner, definition, formula, data source, refresh time and scope.
- Never combine currencies without an approved conversion basis.
- Distinguish cash collected, amounts billed, amounts earned and liabilities held.
- Report permissions must follow underlying record permissions.
- Exports containing personal or financial data require appropriate authorisation and controls.
- Totals must reconcile to transaction-level source reports.

Useful measures

Collections; arrears; occupancy; vacancy; client balances; cash position; outstanding supplier/employee items; work-order ageing; valuation throughput; conversion rates; approval duration; data quality.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: Operational reports, basic finance reports, branch filters, drill-through, export restrictions and key data-quality alerts. Later capability: Advanced BI, forecasting, custom dashboards, report subscriptions, data warehouse, cross-period analysis and carefully governed AI summaries.

Risks to resolve Agree formal KPI definitions and reporting calendar. Poor-quality or duplicated source records will make visually polished dashboards misleading. AppFolio and Yardi demonstrate report drill-through and role-specific visibility [1][4].

5.15 Limited offline operation and synchronisation

Offline operation is a restricted continuity feature. It should support selected work when connectivity is poor, but it must not create a second uncontrolled source of truth or allow users to finalise financial events without server validation.

Typical workflow User signs in while online → permitted data set is synchronised to the device → user creates an allowed local draft or queued action → application labels it as pending → connection returns → server checks identity, access, version, rules, duplicates and approvals → action is accepted, rejected or sent for conflict review.

Capabilities required

- An explicit offline profile listing allowed records, fields, relationships and actions.
- Least-data local cache, based on assigned company/branch and actual task requirements.
- Clear offline indicator, last successful sync time, queue count and data freshness.
- Queue records with unique operation ID, device/user identity, creation time, payload version and retry metadata.
- Separate draft preparation from official financial posting.
- Conflict detection for records changed on the server after the device last synchronised.
- Server-side permission and business-rule recheck on every queued action.
- Conflict-resolution screen with server version, local proposal, conflict reason and authorised reviewer.
- Retry-safe sync that detects an already processed operation instead of repeating it.
- Local data protection, logout/device-loss response, cache clearing, expiry and permissions revocation behaviour.
- Telemetry and support information that help staff explain failed synchronisation without exposing sensitive content.

Principal records and relationships

Offline profile, local draft, queued operation, sync attempt, server acknowledgement, conflict, rejected operation, device/session state and audit event.

Controls and exception handling

- Do not mark queued payment evidence as confirmed cash received.
- Do not allow offline actions to bypass access expiry or approval thresholds.
- A retry must not duplicate an accepted server operation.
- Do not resolve money conflicts by last-write-wins.
- Delete cached data according to explicit security rules on logout, revocation or risk event.
- Do not download all records that a user can theoretically access; synchronise only the approved subset.

Useful measures

Queue age; sync success/failure; conflict rate; rejected queue items; duplicate prevention incidents; last-sync age; stale-cache users.

Delivery boundary

Initial release: Offline-friendly drafts and selected task capture; queued submission; visible sync states; server acceptance required for official financial posting. Later capability: Expanded mobile offline use after security, data scope and conflict procedures are proven.

Risks to resolve Confirm exact offline actions and whether sensitive tenant data may be cached. Offline architecture must be tested on target devices and poor connections. Microsoft’s published offline approach reinforces the need for defined profiles, local storage, sync and conflict handling [14].

6. Common data model and information lifecycle

The database model must be designed from business entities and the relationships between them. The list below is a logical inventory. It is not a final table schema or migration script. Field names, constraints and indexes should follow the approved architecture and detailed process maps.

6.1 Core entity groups

Group	Principal records	Design requirement
Organisation and access	Companies, branches, user identities, company memberships, branch memberships, roles, permissions, temporary access grants, audit events.	Apply company and branch scope to all records where relevant. Do not infer access solely from user title.
Shared client register	Clients, contacts, communication preferences, addresses, relationships, restricted identity/tax fields.	Support multiple roles and relationships without duplicating the same person or organisation.
Property operations	Properties, units, owner/management mandates, tenants, tenancies, rent schedules, charge definitions, charges, deposits, inspections.	Keep property, unit, tenancy and financial events separate. Preserve effective dates and history.
Collections and statements	Payments, allocations, receipts, refunds, reversals, credit adjustments, arrears actions, client ledgers, landlord statements and payouts.	Source payments and allocation events must be traceable; statements should derive from approved transactions.
Finance	Accounts, financial periods, invoices, invoice lines, journal entries, journal lines, bank/cash accounts, reconciliations, currencies, exchange rates and dimensions.	Avoid independently editable duplicated balances. Use fixed-precision money values and approved posting rules.
Spend and procurement	Expense requests, request lines, approval workflows/actions, supplier quotations, purchase orders, goods/services receipts, supplier invoices/payments, petty cash accounts, advances, claims and retirements.	Track request, approval, commitment, issue, claim, actual payment and reconciliation as different states.
CSV imports	Import batches, source files, source rows, mapping profiles, validation issues, matching candidates, import decisions and reconciliation results.	Preserve original source values and prevent duplicate postings on retry.
Valuation operations	Valuation jobs, instructions, engagement files, milestones, assignments, site visits if used, deliverable metadata, job costs, invoices and job events.	Operational delivery status must be separate from the financial status.
Sales and marketing	Leads, opportunities, listings, viewings, offers, transactions, commissions, campaigns, communication events, source attribution and content assets.	Preserve lead history and marketing source; link concluded deals to property/tenancy and finance records.
Maintenance and suppliers	Maintenance requests, work orders, assignments, schedules, quotations, suppliers, invoices, parts, warranties, acceptance evidence and history.	A repair has a work lifecycle, cost lifecycle, service-level target and property relationship.
HR and tasks	Employees, employment records, leave requests, attendance if used, training, credentials, tasks, documents, notifications and comments.	Separate confidential HR data from ordinary management data. Preserve task and approval history.
System operations	Integration settings, idempotency keys, scheduled jobs, sync queues, error events, backups, retention policies and configuration versions.	Make automation observable, retry-safe, supportable and auditable.

6.2 Shared fields and record design

- Stable primary identifier that is not derived from a person's name or a changeable label.
- Company and branch reference where the record belongs to a specific scope.
- Created timestamp and creator; updated timestamp and actor where appropriate.
- Business status with documented allowed transitions.
- Effective date or transaction date where historical periods matter.
- Currency code and amount fields for any monetary value, plus conversion attributes if applicable.
- Source and provenance for imported, automated, or externally provided data.
- Linked documents and evidence with access policy.
- Version or event history for records with material status or value changes.
- Soft archive or controlled retirement when a record must no longer be used; financial history must remain intact.

6.3 Record lifecycle and source of truth

A single transaction may appear in several views. The views must not create several independent financial truths. For example, the tenant statement, arrears report, landlord statement and branch collection report should read from the same validated charge/payment/allocation history. If a discrepancy is found, the system should identify the records that cause it and provide a controlled correction workflow.

6.4 Money and number handling

- Use fixed-precision numeric storage for money. Do not use floating-point arithmetic for official balances.
- Store original transaction currency and amount. Retain the rate, rate date, rate source, translated value and rounding method where conversion is applied.
- Define the treatment of partial payments, split allocation, credit balances, refunds, reversals and exchange differences.
- Keep identifiers, account numbers and provider reference numbers as strings when leading zeros or exact character preservation matters.
- Use server timestamps and a documented business time zone. Retain import-source time where it differs from system time.

7. Roles and permission model

Roles should represent responsibilities. They should not give broad access merely because an employee is senior. Permissions should be assigned through company and branch membership, with additional scoped grants where approved.

Role profile	Typical permitted responsibilities	Default restrictions
Platform operations administrator	Operate platform configuration, service health, support and recovery procedures.	No standing permission to browse customer financial/property records unless separately authorised and logged.
Company super administrator	Manage company settings, branches, memberships, roles, scoped access and selected business configuration.	Cannot override mandatory audit history or erase posted financial events.
Company/branch manager	Review work queues and reports, approve defined requests and manage assigned staff/branches.	No unrestricted access to another company; approval scope is based on assigned authority.
Property manager	Manage properties, units, tenants, tenancies, charges and operational issues within assigned scope.	Cannot self-approve high-risk financial actions outside granted limits.
Finance officer	Review collections, allocate payments, manage invoices, prepare payouts, imports and reconciliations.	Posting, payment release and period reopening may require separate authority.
Finance controller/accountant	Maintain approved accounting configuration,	Cannot bypass access controls or silently edit

Role profile	Typical permitted responsibilities	Default restrictions
	review postings, reconcile and close periods.	posted records.
Requisition requester	Submit requests, attach evidence and track own requests and employee balances.	Cannot approve own request or change payment status.
Approver	Approve or reject requests within assigned category, amount, branch and company scope.	Cannot approve beyond limits or edit the underlying evidence to force approval.
Petty cash custodian	Record imprest movements, cash counts, receipts and replenishment requests.	Must not control every approval and reconciliation step for the same float where separation is feasible.
Sales/lettings agent	Manage own leads, viewings, offers and assigned listings.	Restricted access to financial and tenant documents not needed for the job.
Valuation manager/valuer	Manage assigned valuation jobs, milestones, evidence and delivery status.	No valuation-report generation or valuation calculation is implied by this project scope.
Maintenance coordinator	Triage work orders, assign suppliers, track evidence and prepare cost requests.	Cannot finalise own high-value expenditure approval without independent review.
HR officer	Manage authorised employee records, leave and employment tasks.	Confidential staff data restricted to explicit HR roles.
Internal auditor/read-only reviewer	Read approved records, reports and audit trails for assigned scope.	Cannot change source records, approve own access or post financial transactions.

7.1 Approval design rules

- Every approval policy has an owner, scope, conditions, sequence, amount limit and effective date.
- The system selects approvers from configured authority, not from a free-text name entered by the requester.
- Use separate review, approval, payment execution and reconciliation roles where risk justifies the separation.
- A substitute approver must have recorded delegation and the correct company/branch scope.
- Rejected requests require a reason and can be resubmitted with version history.
- Changes after approval must trigger reapproval if they affect amount, beneficiary, scope or other controlled fields.
- Emergency actions may use a special path, but must create a prompt retrospective review rather than disappear from normal controls.

8. Security, privacy, compliance and resilience

8.1 Security controls

- Authentication should use a managed, security-reviewed identity service. Multi-factor authentication should be considered for privileged and finance users.
- Enforce company and branch permissions in server-side business logic and database policies. Test direct API/database access, not only the visible interface.
- Use least privilege, default deny, separate roles and restricted administrative access.
- Protect secrets and integration credentials. Do not expose database service keys or privileged credentials to a browser client.
- Encrypt network traffic and use protected storage for documents and backups. Define key access and rotation processes.
- Maintain audit events for logins, access changes, approvals, sensitive reads/exports where required, imports, financial postings and corrections.
- Validate uploaded files, restrict file types and size, scan files where available, and protect against unauthorised document links.
- Apply rate limits and abuse protection to authentication, file imports and exposed endpoints.
- Separate development, test and production data and credentials. Use masked or synthetic data for testing when possible.

- Monitor background tasks, CSV import jobs, notifications, scheduled billing and offline synchronisation. Alert on failures.

8.2 Privacy and data governance

The product will process personal information about tenants, landlords, prospects, employees, suppliers and business contacts. The company must identify its data-protection role, document purposes and access, assess service-provider responsibilities, and establish the applicable privacy and retention controls. The Kenyan Office of the Data Protection Commissioner provides official information about data controllers and processors [19]. This brief does not determine the legal role or obligations for a specific company.

- Define what personal data is necessary for each workflow and do not collect fields “just in case”.
- Define who may view identity documents, contact details, employment records, bank details and legal correspondence.
- Define retention, correction, export, deletion or anonymisation rules with professional advice and applicable law.
- Record and investigate suspected data breaches under the company’s incident procedure.
- Assess hosting region, cross-border processing, backups, service providers and contracts before production.
- Provide controlled export and access logs for sensitive data.

8.3 Tax and integration compliance

The Kenyan eTIMS service provides system-to-system integration routes for invoicing systems [18]. The project should assess whether an integration is required for the company’s actual activities and tax status. The implementation plan must document the relevant API, credentials, acknowledgement/validation behaviour, retry rules, invoice numbering interaction and failure process. The system must not claim compliance simply because an API connector exists.

8.4 Backup, recovery and continuity

- Define recovery point objective (acceptable data-loss window) and recovery time objective (acceptable outage duration) with the business.
- Maintain automated backups and a separate protected backup location according to the approved operating model.
- Test restoration from backup on a schedule. A backup that has never been restored is not proven.
- Record who can initiate restoration, approve rollback and verify restored financial totals.
- Keep database migrations and application releases versioned and reversible where practical.
- Prepare a service-outage process for rent collection, receipts, cash handling and urgent maintenance. Avoid uncontrolled parallel spreadsheets.
- Test handling of incomplete scheduled billing/import/sync jobs after an outage.

8.5 Minimum acceptance security tests

- A user from Company A cannot retrieve Company B data by changing record IDs.
- A branch user cannot read another branch’s records through an API call unless an approved scope exists.
- Expired or revoked cross-branch access fails for UI and API requests.
- A user cannot approve their own request when a separation rule applies.
- A browser cannot access privileged backend credentials.
- A retry of the same payment/import action does not duplicate an official transaction.
- A posted transaction cannot be changed without a traceable reversal/adjustment.
- An unauthorised user cannot retrieve a document by guessing or reusing a link.

9. Integrations and future capabilities

Integration area	Initial position	Design requirements and future path
CSV statements	Initial payment import method.	Keep a generic import adapter, source-file provenance, mappings, staging, idempotency and exceptions. Add provider-

Integration area	Initial position	Design requirements and future path
		specific rules without changing core payment records.
Banking/payment providers	No direct integration assumed at launch.	Review official bank/provider channels, security, fees, settlement evidence, webhook signatures, retries and reconciliation before use.
M-Pesa	Evaluate after CSV workflow is proven.	Use supported official access where available. Distinguish transaction notification from confirmed settlement and matched customer payment.
KRA eTIMS	Compliance assessment required.	Evaluate applicable invoicing rules and official system-to-system options [18]. Keep tax policy, invoice state and API acknowledgement traceable.
Email/SMS/WhatsApp	In-app notifications first; external channels later.	Use approved providers, templates, delivery status, contact preference, retry handling and opt-out/retention controls.
Document signatures	Later, if operationally useful.	Preserve the signed version, signer/authority, timestamp, provider reference and audit proof.
Office productivity/storage	To be decided.	Assess calendar, email, collaboration and protected document integration. Avoid storing the only copy of critical evidence in a user's mailbox.
Accounting package	Unresolved.	Determine whether this system becomes the official ledger or passes validated events to another accounting system. Reconcile totals and correction processes in either case.
Mobile application	Responsive web foundation first.	Use the same permission and business APIs. Package for Android/iOS only after touch workflow, storage security and offline rules are validated.
Analytics / data warehouse	Later stage.	Use governed data definitions, refresh metadata and source lineage. Do not allow a warehouse to become a competing transaction system.
AI assistance	Optional and later.	Potential uses: summarise an authorised job file, classify import exceptions, draft communications and surface anomalies. Require human review and do not let AI post payments or change permissions autonomously.

9.1 Integration readiness rules

- Each integration needs an owner, supported purpose, source of truth, data scope, authentication method and error-handling rule.
- Use idempotency, correlation IDs and audit events for operations that may be retried.
- Distinguish request accepted, operation processed, payment settled and reconciliation complete.
- Do not allow a provider outage to corrupt the core records or block unrelated module work.
- Use documented versioning and an integration sandbox or controlled test process when available.
- Make credentials revocable and avoid direct, unmonitored manual changes to integration configuration.

10. Phased implementation plan

The release plan should be adjusted only after workflows, access rules, data definitions and accounting assumptions are reviewed. No fixed delivery date is proposed because workload, integration choices, migration quality and testing effort are not yet established.

Phase	Purpose and boundaries	Exit evidence
P0 — Discovery and design	Map processes; validate the module scope; audit current records and workflows; write data dictionary; define roles, approvals, money rules, offline scope, risk register and test plan.	Business owner approval; unresolved decisions documented; design reviews completed; no critical workflow lacks an owner.
P1 — Secure platform foundation	Authentication; company/branch model; memberships; role permissions; audit history; protected documents; shared clients/properties; environments and backups.	Company/branch isolation tests pass; access-review workflow works; recovery process is tested; privileged secrets are protected.
P2 — Property operations	Properties, units, tenants, tenancies, rent schedules, charges, payments, allocations, receipts, arrears and basic landlord statements.	Billing idempotency, partial payment, overpayment, vacancy history, receipt uniqueness and statement reconciliation tests pass.
P3 — Operational finance and cash control	Requisitions; approvals; supplier expense requests; fixed imprest; ad hoc advances; expense claims; retirements; employee balances; CSV imports and reconciliation.	Every payment lifecycle is traceable; role separation is tested; import retry does not duplicate; employee balances reconcile.
P4 — Controlled pilot and opening data	Migrate only validated records; run parallel checks where agreed; train users; test backups/restoration; resolve pilot defects.	Signed opening balances, data exceptions, user acceptance, support procedure and go-live readiness review.
P5 — Wider business operations	Valuation job tracking; sales and lettings; marketing; maintenance/suppliers; HR; expanded reports.	Each module has acceptance criteria, owner, support process and connected financial/record links.
P6 — Advanced capabilities	Broader offline support, provider integrations, eTIMS where applicable, external messaging, client portals, analytics and mobile packaging.	Each integration has security, reconciliation, monitoring and rollback tests; offline conflicts are handled safely.

10.1 Delivery discipline for any development team or coding agent

- Inspect the existing implementation before making a change. State the files, workflows and records the change affects.
- Propose a bounded task with explicit exclusions. Do not rebuild validated functions to achieve cosmetic consistency.
- Implement only the approved scope. Do not expand database permissions, remove constraints or change financial calculations without a separate review.
- Run relevant tests and report commands/results, passed checks, failed checks and untested areas.
- Review the interface and test error/empty/loading/conflict states, not only the happy path.
- For financial or access changes, test direct server/database calls and migration effects.
- Report unresolved defects honestly. Do not declare completion because code was generated or a screen renders.

11. Acceptance and test catalogue

These tests define expected behaviour. The detailed test suite should include synthetic records, multiple company/branch contexts, concurrent users, retry cases, failure cases and realistic financial scenarios. Amounts below should be selected by the business and accountant when required.

Test area	Acceptance condition
Organisation isolation	Attempt to read and modify a different company's property, tenant, file, payment and report through direct API requests. All unauthorised actions fail.
Branch restrictions	Branch user cannot query another branch unless a valid access grant allows the specific action.
Access expiry	A cross-branch grant expires; old browser session and queued offline changes are denied or held for review.
Approval separation	A requester cannot self-approve a restricted request. An authorised approver can approve only within limits.
Approval change control	Changing amount, payee, currency or scope after approval invalidates approval when policy requires reapproval.
Recurring rent generation	Running the same billing period twice produces no duplicate charge.
Rent change history	Changing rent with a future effective date does not alter prior approved charges.
Partial payment	A partial receipt reduces the correct outstanding charge by the allocated amount and leaves the remainder open.
Payment across charges	A permitted allocation splits one payment across multiple charges without duplicating cash received.
Overpayment	Excess funds are represented as a defined credit or unallocated balance and do not create negative/incorrect charge balances.
Duplicate receipt protection	Concurrent attempts or repeated requests cannot issue two new receipts for the same authorised payment event.
Reversal	Reversing a payment preserves source and reversal history, corrects balances and records author/reason.
Tenancy history	Moving out a tenant preserves previous tenancy, charges, receipts, documents and statement history.
Client-fund integrity	Collections, fees, approved costs, refunds and landlord payouts reconcile to the client liability under the approved model.
Cash vs accrual reporting	Cash and accrual views use documented policy and do not silently present the same metric as interchangeable.
Currency correctness	Foreign-currency transaction retains original amount, currency, exchange rate/date and base-currency equivalent.
CSV duplicate import	Uploading the same source file twice cannot create duplicate financial postings.
CSV exception handling	Malformed, unmatched and duplicate candidate rows remain visible and do not automatically become posted receipts.
Statement reconciliation	Imported statement opening/closing balance and transaction totals reconcile; unexplained differences prevent silent closure.
Advance lifecycle	Approved advance is not marked paid until actual issue of funds is recorded.
Staff balances	Employee amount owed to company and company amount owed to employee remain separate and reconcile to transactions.
Petty cash count	Physical cash count differing from book balance creates a variance and requires explanation/review.
Supplier payment	Supplier payment requires a validated invoice or authorised

Test area	Acceptance condition
	exception and links to actual payment evidence.
Valuation completion	Completed/delivered but unpaid valuation jobs remain visible as unpaid, without falsely showing receipt of cash.
Valuation deliverable	Issued version, recipient, release authoriser and issue date remain traceable.
Maintenance close	Work order cannot pass required completion checks without evidence or a recorded, authorised exception.
Landlord expense recovery	Non-approved or non-recoverable property expense is not silently deducted from landlord funds.
Document authorisation	A user without permission cannot access sensitive documents by guessing a URL or reusing an expired link.
Offline duplicate retry	Repeated sync of one operation is idempotent. An accepted record is not created twice.
Offline conflict	Server record changed during offline period; queue raises conflict and does not overwrite newer official data.
Audit trace	For a sensitive transaction, auditor can reconstruct who created, approved, paid, allocated, reversed and reconciled it.
Backup restoration	Restore a backup into a controlled environment and reconcile row counts, key totals and system usability.
Report drill-down	Headline totals equal the authorised source records under the same date, currency and scope filters.

12. Risk register

Level	Risk	Control / mitigation	Owner
Critical	Company or branch data leakage	Enforce server/database access; default deny; direct access tests; audit privileged access.	Product/security owner
Critical	Incorrect client-fund or landlord balance	Accountant-approved model; separate client liability ledger; payout controls; monthly reconciliation.	Finance owner
Critical	Duplicate or incorrect payment posting	Idempotency; source-row retention; payment allocation constraints; review exceptions; reversal process.	Finance/product owner
High	Incorrect opening balances or migrated histories	Audit records first; test copy; map fields; reconcile totals; sign-off and rollback plan.	Migration owner/finance
High	Offline queue bypasses current permission or duplicates a transaction	Server revalidation; unique operation IDs; conflict handling; no final offline posting.	Technical/security owner
High	Accounting and property ledgers disagree	Common transaction source; defined postings; controlled adjustments; cross-module reconciliation tests.	Finance/product owner
High	CSV formats change or parse incorrectly	Import profiles; file validation; preview; mapping versioning;	Finance operations

Level	Risk	Control / mitigation	Owner
		sample-file regression tests.	
High	Scope expands beyond usable MVP	Prioritised acceptance criteria; phase gates; change control; defer portals/AI/advanced offline.	Product owner
High	Sensitive documents are overexposed	Record-level permissions; signed/expiring links; export controls; privacy review.	Security/privacy owner
High	Approval conflicts of interest	Segregation of duties; limits; delegation controls; exception review and audit.	Finance/operations
High	Unreliable reporting from weak definitions	Metric register; data-quality alerts; drill-through; signed reporting definitions.	Management/BI owner
Medium	External provider outage disrupts operations	Retry-safe integrations; failure queue; operational outage procedure; reconciliations.	Operations/technical owner
Medium	Users return to side spreadsheets	User testing; training; migration and cutover; visible exceptions; clear ownership of source records.	Business change owner
Medium	Backup exists but cannot be restored	Scheduled restore test; measure recovery objectives; record evidence and corrective actions.	Technical operations
Medium	Automation runs twice or silently fails	Idempotent jobs; monitoring; run history; alerting; manual retry with safeguards.	Technical operations

13. Decisions required before implementation

The following decisions remain open. A recommended direction is included where useful, but it must be confirmed by the business owner and relevant specialists.

Area	Question to resolve	Recommended starting point
Organisation	Can one person belong to multiple companies? What legal and operational separation exists between independent companies?	Support multiple memberships, each with separate scope; confirm the business use cases.
Company administration	Who appoints/replaces the company super administrator? How is account recovery handled?	Define a verified recovery process with logged, time-limited support actions.
Cross-branch access	Which role approves access, what actions can be granted, and can emergency access be granted?	Purpose, scope, reason, approval, expiry and audit. Emergency use requires retrospective review.
Offline tasks	Which tasks and fields must work offline? Is local storage allowed to include tenant documents or financial details?	Start with drafts and selected low-risk tasks; keep official posting online.
CSV sources	Which banks/providers are first? Provide sample files with sensitive data masked.	CSV mapping profiles, preserved source rows and a test corpus for each format.
Petty cash	What float limits, custodians, replenishment frequency, advance limits and receipt exceptions apply?	Define separate policies for fixed imprest, ad hoc advances and reimbursements.
Client funds	How are rent and deposits held? Are funds pooled or held in separate accounts? Who	Map actual banking arrangements and obtain professional accounting/compliance review.

Area	Question to resolve	Recommended starting point
	approves payouts?	
Accounting basis	What system is the official general ledger now and in the future? What is the formal accounting basis?	Design accrual-ready operational data; do not finalise accounting treatment until approved.
Currency	What is each company's base/reporting currency? Which foreign currencies are needed at launch?	KSh may be the default for an initial Kenyan deployment, but support explicit currencies and a documented rate policy.
Taxes and e-invoicing	Which tax registrations, invoice rules and eTIMS requirements apply to each company?	Obtain current advice; assess official KRA integration requirements [18].
Valuation operations	What job categories, engagement documents, milestone templates and fee/invoice triggers are used?	Define by service type and review the applicable professional requirements [17].
Property rules	How are service charges, utilities, deposits, late fees, vacant-unit charges and landlord expenses determined?	Document rule owner, effective date, authority, calculation, exceptions and statement treatment.
Sales and lettings	What stages, approval points, commission rules and listing sources are used?	Use separate configurable pipelines and a documented handoff to property management.
HR scope	Will the first release include payroll, attendance devices, recruitment or only staff records and leave?	Defer payroll calculations unless requirements and local rules are fully specified.
Privacy and retention	What retention periods, lawful purposes, access procedures and provider contracts apply?	Complete privacy/data mapping with a qualified local adviser and relevant authority guidance [19].
Migration	Which historic period must be migrated? What makes a record valid? Is a parallel reconciliation period needed?	Audit first, test mapping, compare opening balances and receive written acceptance before production use.
Deployment	What does hybrid deployment mean operationally: hosted service with offline app, local server, or both?	Preferred working assumption: central hosted service with limited local offline capability; confirm network and recovery needs.
Mobile	Is responsive web sufficient for the pilot, or are native store apps required?	Prove responsive workflows first. Package later if device APIs/offline use justify it.
Official reports	Who approves definitions for arrears, collections, revenue, client funds, profit, vacancy and turnaround?	Maintain a KPI glossary with formulas and owners before management dashboards go live.
Data hosting and vendors	Which hosting region, document storage, authentication provider and third-party services are acceptable?	Assess security, processing agreements, resilience, support and cost before selecting vendors.

14. Recommended product shape and success criteria

14.1 The product in one sentence

Product statement

A secure, multi-company, multi-branch real-estate operating system that connects property operations, financial control, valuation jobs, sales and lettings, maintenance, staff administration and management reporting through shared records, controlled workflows and auditable transactions.

14.2 What the first usable release must prove

- A property manager can maintain accurate properties, units, tenancies, charges, payments, allocations, receipts, arrears and landlord statements.
- A finance officer can import a CSV, identify duplicates and exceptions, reconcile the statement and explain every posted transaction.
- An employee can request money, receive an approved advance, submit evidence, return unused cash and see the correct remaining balance.
- A manager can approve only within their authority, and cannot use their role to gain unrestricted cross-company access.
- A completed valuation job remains visible until its fees, collections and direct costs are properly tracked.
- A maintenance job can be approved, assigned, evidenced, checked and linked to the appropriate financial record.
- A report can drill into source records and reconcile to the same authoritative transactions.
- A failed sync, duplicate import or partial processing event can be identified and resolved without silently corrupting official data.
- A tested backup can be restored and key balances verified.

14.3 Capabilities to defer until the foundation is proven

- Public self-service portals for tenants, landlords, suppliers or customers.
- Full offline editing of official financial records.
- Automatic bank/payment posting without exception review.
- Advanced AI agents that approve, post, pay or change permissions without human control.
- A fully featured payroll or local tax engine without validated requirements.
- Complex multi-book/consolidated accounting before the formal accounting model is approved.
- Automated valuation calculation or valuation report generation, which are outside the intended scope of the valuation module.
- Customisable workflow builders that permit unrestricted control changes by ordinary users.

14.4 Definition of project success

The system is successful when it becomes the trusted place where authorised staff do the work, where financial records reconcile to independent evidence, where client money is distinguishable from company money, where approvals and exceptions are visible, where managers can explain the numbers, and where the company can expand the platform without losing control of data or business rules.

Success does not mean that every listed capability exists in the first release. Success means that the roadmap delivers useful capabilities in controlled stages and that each release meets its defined acceptance tests.

15. Reference sources and benchmark notes

The following sources were reviewed for documented product and regulatory capability patterns. Supplier documentation describes the supplier's product and is not an independent performance evaluation. The requirements in this brief are design recommendations based on the project context; they do not imply endorsement of a supplier.

[1] Yardi Voyager Residential
Property management, accounting, leasing workflows, role-based views and reporting.
https://www.yardi.com/product/voyager-residential/

[2] Buildium - Property Management Accounting
Property-management accounting, payments, bills and bank reconciliation.
https://www.buildium.com/features/property-management-accounting/

[3] Buildium - Property Owner Portal and owner statement help
Owner reports, contributions, documents and statement concepts.
https://www.buildium.com/features/property-owner-portal/ | https://help.buildium.com/hc/s/article/Rental-owner-statement-1557494407490

[4] AppFolio - Property Management and Accounting/Reporting
Connected leasing, maintenance, accounting, owner reporting and unit-turn concepts.
https://www.appfolio.com/property-management-software | https://www.appfolio.com/property-manager/accounting-reporting/

[5] Odoo 18 Accounting and Invoicing documentation
Double-entry bookkeeping, cash/accrual reporting, multi-company and multi-currency concepts.
https://www.odoo.com/documentation/18.0/applications/finance/accounting.html

[6] Odoo 18 - Import bank transactions
CSV imports and other statement import workflows.
https://www.odoo.com/documentation/18.0/applications/finance/accounting/bank/transactions.html

[7] Odoo 18 - Expenses and approval/posting
Separate expense submission, approval, posting, reimbursement and re-invoicing.
https://www.odoo.com/documentation/18.0/applications/finance/expenses.html | https://www.odoo.com/documentation/18.0/applications/finance/expenses/approve_expenses.html

[8] Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central - Set up approval workflows
Workflow steps, user approval and automated task patterns.
https://learn.microsoft.com/en-gb/dynamics365/business-central/across-set-up-workflows

[9] Microsoft Dynamics 365 Business Central - Financial management
General ledger, dimensions, currencies and financial configuration.
https://learn.microsoft.com/dynamics365/business-central/finance

[10] Oracle NetSuite - Multiple currencies in OneWorld
Subsidiary base-currency configuration and foreign-currency transactions.
https://docs.oracle.com/en/cloud/saas/netsuite/ns-online-help/section_N269257.html

[11] Oracle NetSuite - Multi-Book Accounting Overview
Multiple accounting books based on shared transaction events and reporting needs.
https://docs.oracle.com/en/cloud/saas/netsuite/ns-online-help/chapter_3831567542.html

[12] Zoho People - Approval overview and use cases
Configurable approval processes for employee requests.
https://help.zoho.com/portal/en/kb/people/administrator-guide/common-settings/articles/approvals-overview-use-cases

[13] Zoho CRM - Lead management
Lead assignment, qualification, nurture and conversion measurement.
https://www.zoho.com/crm/enterprise/solutions/lead-management.html

[14] Microsoft Power Apps - Offline-first and synchronisation
Offline profiles, local records, synchronisation and conflict handling.
https://learn.microsoft.com/power-apps/mobile/mobile-offline-works-overview

[15] Microsoft Dynamics 365 Field Service - Work orders
Work order, tasks, products/services, scheduling and field execution.
https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/dynamics365/field-service/create-work-order

[16] Odoo 18 Maintenance
Corrective/preventive maintenance, scheduling, teams, equipment and request tracking.
https://www.odoo.com/documentation/18.0/applications/inventory_and_mrp/maintenance.html

[17] RICS - Best practice for registered valuers
Terms of engagement and valuation instruction/report frameworks.
https://www.rics.org/regulation/regulatory-schemes/valuer-registration/best-practice-for-registered-valuers

[18] Kenya Revenue Authority - eTIMS system-to-system integration
Official eTIMS API integration information, including VSCU and OSCU routes.
https://www.kra.go.ke/business/etims-electronic-tax-invoice-management-system/learn-about-etims/etims-system-to-system-integration

[19] Office of the Data Protection Commissioner (Kenya)
Official data protection authority and controller/processor information.
https://www.odpc.go.ke/

Research limitations

This is a feature and requirements benchmark, not a procurement comparison. Supplier claims were not independently measured. Product editions, pricing, geographic availability, integrations and terms can change. Compliance applicability depends on the company's facts and must be verified with current primary guidance and professional advisers before implementation. The product design should be checked against real business examples and actual sample data before development is authorised.